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FREE 3-MINUTE SCORECARD

Which language should you translate your book into first?

THE INDIE AUTHOR MARKET-MATCH SCORECARD

Compare five language markets and find a promising first language for your book.

DE	ES	FR	IT	PT
German	Spanish	French	Italian	Portuguese

How to use your scorecard

1. Choose your genre
Copy the starting scores from page 2.

2. Add what you know about your readers
Use the criteria on page 2 to complete the tally on page 3.

3. Compare your totals
Take a closer look at your top language on page 4. Use page 5 if scores are close.

Have sales dashboards, mailing-list locations or reader messages handy. You don’t need all the answers yet. Use what you already know, and score zero wherever you’re unsure.

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STEPS 1 AND 2

Build your market scores

Copy your genre row into the tally sheet, then add what you already know about your readers for each language.

A. Start with genre fit

3 = strongest fit / 2 = promising / 1 = more selective

Genre	DE	ES	FR	IT	PT
Romance	**3**	**2**	**2**	**3**	**2**
Fantasy	**3**	**2**	**3**	**2**	**2**
Thriller / crime	**3**	**3**	**3**	**3**	**2**
Science fiction	**3**	**2**	**3**	**2**	**2**
Nonfiction	**3**	**3**	**3**	**2**	**3**

DE = German / ES = Spanish / FR = French / IT = Italian / PT = Portuguese

B. What do you already know about your readers?

Reader interest (0-4)
0 = none / **1** = one isolated enquiry / **2** = occasional interest / **3** = repeated requests or enquiries
4 = existing sales or an engaged group of subscribers in that market

Ways to reach readers (0-2)
0 = no route in / **1** = some contacts / **2** = reviewer, partner or community access

Series potential (0-2)
0 = standalone / **1** = related titles / **2** = a series you could continue translating

Ready to promote (0-2)
0 = not ready yet / **1** = basic launch / **2** = localised blurb, ads and advance-reader/review plan

These genre scores are a starting guide. What you know about your own readers matters more.

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STEP 3

Your market-match tally

Write one number in every box, then add each language column. Maximum score: 13 points.

Factor	DE	ES	FR	IT	PT
Genre fit (1-3)					
Reader interest (0-4)					
Ways to reach readers (0-2)					
Series potential (0-2)					
Ready to promote (0-2)					
TOTAL / 13					

My strongest first market is:

My runner-up is:

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READ YOUR RESULT

Take a closer look at your top language

Use these profiles to investigate your leading language. A lower score means a less clear first test, but it doesn’t mean you should rule it out.

DE

German

A focused European launch when you know which readers your book will appeal to.

Next check: Look for German reader signals and comparable translated titles.

ES

Spanish

A broad language spanning distinct markets. Choose Spain or Latin America.

Next check: Choose the regional edition before translation and marketing.

FR

French

A multi-country language relevant across fiction and nonfiction.

Next check: Define your primary storefront and reader profile.

IT

Italian

A focused test when your genre fit and localised launch plan are clear.

Next check: Identify comparable Italian editions and ways to help readers find your book.

PT

Portuguese

Different reader markets: choose Portugal or Brazil before translation.

Next check: Confirm the language variant and primary Amazon market.

Regional choices matter. Plan Spanish and Portuguese editions for a specific region, rather than treating either language as a universal market.

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DECIDE AND TEST

Choose your next move

If two markets finish two points or fewer apart, use the questions below. Then turn your choice into a small, measurable launch.

Close result? Use this tie-breaker for each language

Can I describe the target reader in one clear sentence?	☐ YES	☐ NO
Can I find at least five comparable translated books?	☐ YES	☐ NO
Do I have a realistic route to reviews or reader feedback?	☐ YES	☐ NO
Could I support the launch for 30 days after publication?	☐ YES	☐ NO

Choose the market with more yes answers. Still tied? Start small with one book and learn before expanding your series.

Four steps to a first market test

01 Choose one region	Define country, language variant and storefront.
02 Check comparable books	Review covers, prices, categories and reader expectations.
03 Price the translation	Use your word count to understand the investment.
04 Plan how readers will find your book	Prepare your blurb, keywords, reviews and a 30-day launch.

My next action this week: _____

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YOU HAVE YOUR FIRST MARKET

Now find out what your translation would cost

A managed route to your next edition

BookLingua combines AI manuscript translation with a separate editorial pass, consistency checks, targeted professional translator review and localised launch materials.

Targeted professional review covers selected passages, rather than a full-manuscript human proofread.

Visit BookLingua to get a personalised translation estimate:

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Your estimate is shown before checkout. No obligation.

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